

Islander + Gwaii Engineering

Two linked Victoria civil firms - and a clean lane for KOR on Vancouver Island & Indigenous work

The relationship cluster

Islander Engineering (civil / land-dev, est. 2016) and Gwaii Engineering (Indigenous-owned civil & environmental, est. 2017) are sibling firms: Corey Brown co-founded both, and senior staff (Mike Achtem, Jared Smylie) appear at each. One relationship - Corey Brown - opens both doors. Neither firm has any prior KOR contractual history (confirmed absent from Deltek): this is net-new white space.

Why it matters to KOR

- Complementary, non-competing: KOR is structural; both firms are civil/environmental. They pair on the same prime-consultant teams and never bid against KOR.
- Indigenous participation: Gwaii is CCAB-certified and Indigenous-owned - a KOR+Gwaii team scores Indigenous-participation credit on the public RFQs that increasingly require it.
- Incumbency KOR lacks: Gwaii is the embedded civil engineer for 25+ First Nations + BC Housing on the coast - exactly the owners KOR is chasing but has not yet won.

Shared client overlap (KOR is already pursuing these)

BC Housing (KOR tracks 50 projects as owner), Cowichan Tribes, Malahat Nation, Tsawout, Tsawwassen, Songhees, Esquimalt, Ditidaht, Ucluelet First Nation, Haida Nation, Tla'amin, Tsain-Ko, Comox Valley / Strathcona, and School Districts 50 (Haida Gwaii), 71 (Comox) and 79 (Cowichan) - all currently in KOR's pursuit graph with zero KOR projects won (open targets).

Plays for KOR

- PLAY 1 - Indigenous teaming: propose KOR structural + Gwaii civil on First Nations / BC Housing pursuits where Gwaii is incumbent. KOR supplies structural depth; team gains CCAB scoring + Gwaii's warm client access.
- PLAY 2 - Vancouver Island land-dev: KOR structural capacity for Islander's land-development & missing-middle pipeline.
- PLAY 3 - One entry, two firms: build the relationship through Corey Brown; let it branch to Gwaii (Nation/BC-Housing) and Islander (land-dev).
- PLAY 4 - Strike on the live triggers: KOR is ALREADY pursuing projects on Gwaii-client land - Duncan 'River's Edge' (Cowichan Tribes + BC Housing), Saanichton Tsawout First Nation, Vancouver Island BC Housing (Nanaimo/Saanich/Campbell River), Penticton Skaha (PURSUE_URGENT). Bring Gwaii into these specific pursuits now.

Defence Canada proposal - past-performance reality (for Rory)

Team forming with Yellowridge Construction (GC) + DHK Architects (+ KOR structural, + Islander/Gwaii civil), likely CFB Esquimalt (DCC A/B Jetty Recapitalization). KOR Deltek past-performance check:

- Islander + Gwaii: NO KOR job history - cannot be cited as past performance (net-new teaming only).
- Yellowridge Construction: KOR active job - 611 Brunswick St, Prince George.
- dHKarchitects: KOR active job - All Clan House, Stellako BC (Indigenous Clan House).
- => Anchor the proposal's KOR-team past-performance on Yellowridge + DHK; position Islander/Gwaii as the Vancouver Island civil + Indigenous-participation partner going forward.

Priority contacts

Who	Why	Email
Corey Brown	Bridges both firms; MD at Gwaii (Indigenous lead)	cbrown@gwaiieng.com
Brandon Ducharme	Gwaii Capital Advisory - knows the project pipeline	bducharme@gwaiieng.com
Josh Bartley	Islander CEO - land-dev pipeline	jbartley@islanderengineering.com